

# Diabetes - Low Blood Sugar - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1072 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

## Definition

- Hypoglycemia (low blood sugar) assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

## Clinical background

- Hypoglycaemia is usually a blood-glucose level below 4 mmol/L and should be treated promptly.
- Symptoms can include hunger, sweating, shaking, dizziness, weakness, visual change, irritability, palpitations, and confusion.
- An unconscious person must not be given food or drink by mouth; emergency escalation depends on recovery and glucagon availability.

## Initial assessment

1. [OPEN\_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, what glucose reading and units are shown, what symptoms are present, and what does their personal diabetes/hypoglycaemia plan say?
2. [YES\_NO] Is a glucagon injection available and does someone know how to use it?
3. [YES\_NO] Has the person been drinking alcohol?
4. [PREGNANCY] Is the patient pregnant or possibly pregnant? If yes, record gestation where known.

## Triage and redirect questions

### 1. Redirect → Diabetes - High Blood Sugar

Is the measured glucose high rather than below 4 mmol/L, with thirst, frequent urination, or other hyperglycaemia symptoms?

NHS.UK distinguishes hyperglycaemia from hypoglycaemia; a high reading belongs in the high-blood-sugar pathway.

### 1. Disposition level 100

Is the person unresponsive or unconscious, AND is a glucagon injection unavailable, or has one already been given without recovery within 10 minutes, or has the person been drinking alcohol?

NHS.UK low blood sugar guidance lists these as Qatar 999 criteria for severe hypoglycemia.

### 1. Disposition level 15

Is the person conscious and able to swallow safely, with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance provides the fast-acting sugar treatment steps for a conscious person with low blood sugar.

## Advice

### ***Qatar emergency low-blood-sugar response***

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for reduced consciousness, seizure, unsafe swallowing, severe confusion/aggression, injury, or failure to improve under the person's approved plan. Give prescribed glucagon only if it is available and the helper is trained, following the product/personal plan. Do not give anything by mouth to a drowsy, seizing, or unsafe-to-swallow person; use the recovery position if breathing. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: no improvement under the prescribed rescue plan; worsening unresponsiveness; seizure or abnormal breathing.

### ***Governed fast-acting carbohydrate treatment***

- Only if fully awake and swallowing safely, follow the person's clinician-approved diabetes plan for fast-acting carbohydrate and timed glucose recheck. Product, amount, repeat interval, follow-on food, insulin/pump adjustment, and pediatric/pregnancy actions require the approved Qatar protocol; do not improvise exact doses. Escalate to 999 for deterioration or failure to respond.
- Call Back If: no improvement according to the personal plan; level of consciousness or swallowing worsens; seizure or recurrent episode.

## First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for reduced consciousness, seizure, unsafe swallowing, severe confusion/aggression, injury, or failure to improve under the person's approved plan. Give prescribed glucagon only if it is available and the helper is trained, following the product/personal plan. Do not give anything by mouth to a drowsy, seizing, or unsafe-to-swallow person; use the recovery position if breathing. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

## References

- NHS.UK, "Low blood sugar (hypoglycaemia)", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/low-blood-sugar-hypoglycaemia/> (page last reviewed 03 August 2023)

## Provenance

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